EXPERIMENT 11

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

Bank Loan Application Form — Multi-Stage Deployment Use Case

Submitted by

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1. Aim

To deploy the Bank Loan Application Form built in Zoho Creator from the Development environment to the Stage environment for testing, and then to the Production environment, so that a tested and approved version of the application is live and available to end users.

The application manages loan applications from applicants, including applicant details, contact details, application and repayment dates, interest rate, reason for loan and supporting documents, so changes must be reviewed and tested before they reach live users.

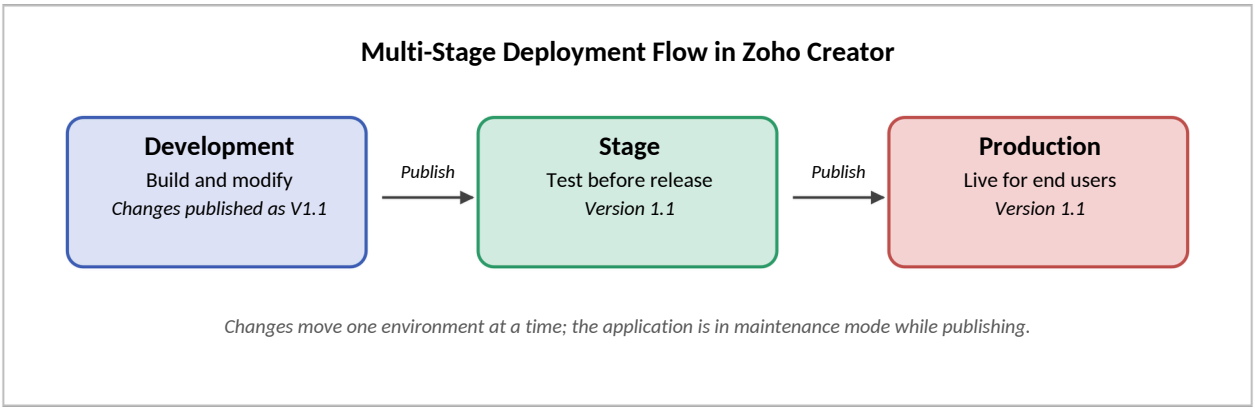
2. Procedure

1. **Review the application in Development** — The dashboard of the Bank Loan Application Form application was checked: charts and summary tiles for loan applications, including applications pending and rejected (Section 3.2).
2. **Open the Environments page** — Deploy > Environments was opened. The Stage and Production columns were listed, with version 1.0 in Production, and a small change made in the loan application form was then detected as Changes available (Section 3.3).
3. **Select components for Stage** — Publish > Publish to Stage was chosen. The modified note field of the loan application form was selected and the Development and Staging code was compared side by side (Section 3.4).
4. **Enter the publish details** — A title, description, version type (Minor) and email notification address were entered; the version change V1.0 to V1.1 was confirmed and the form was published (Section 3.5).
5. **Confirm the Stage deployment** — The "Publish to Stage initiated" message and the completion email from Zoho Creator were checked, and the form was opened in the Stage environment to confirm the change (Section 3.6).
6. **Publish to Production** — After testing in Stage, Publish to Production was started with the Publish Now option and the Environments page was used to track it (Section 3.7).
7. **Verify the live application** — The Production environment and its version were verified on the Environments page (Section 3.7), and the results were summarised (Sections 3.8 and 3.9).

Note: this record is based on screenshots captured during the deployment. Version numbers are reported as shown on screen. Feature names and menu options depend on the Zoho Creator plan and version.

3. Output

3.1 Multi-stage deployment model



Zoho Creator provides three environments. Development is where the application is built, Stage is a testing copy, and Production is the live copy used by end users. A change is published to one environment at a time, so untested work never reaches live users.

3.2 Application overview (Development dashboard)

The dashboard showed charts and summary tiles for the loan applications, including the applications pending and applications rejected tiles.

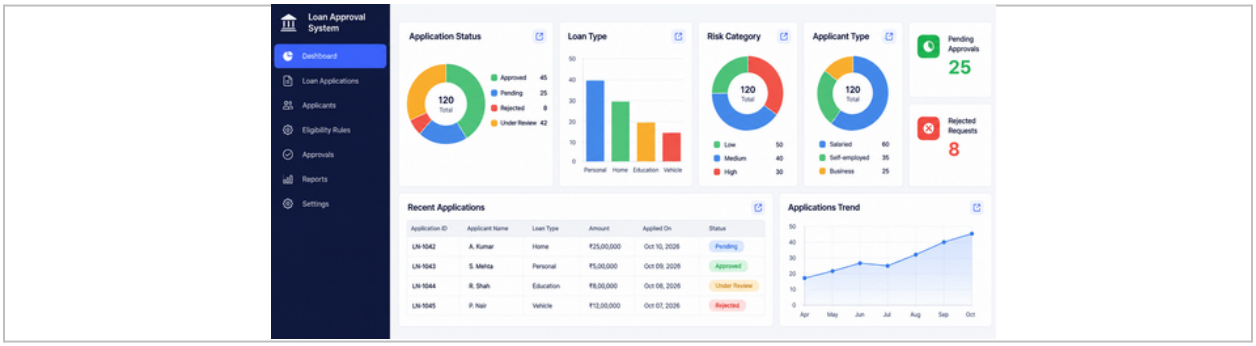


Fig. 1 — Application dashboard showing charts and summary tiles

3.3 Environments page

The Environments page lists the application with Stage and Production columns. When it was first opened, Production held version 1.0 and the Stage column showed “Waiting for development app creation”, because Creator was still setting up the Development copy. After a small change was saved in the loan application form, the label Changes available showed that Development had changes ready to publish.

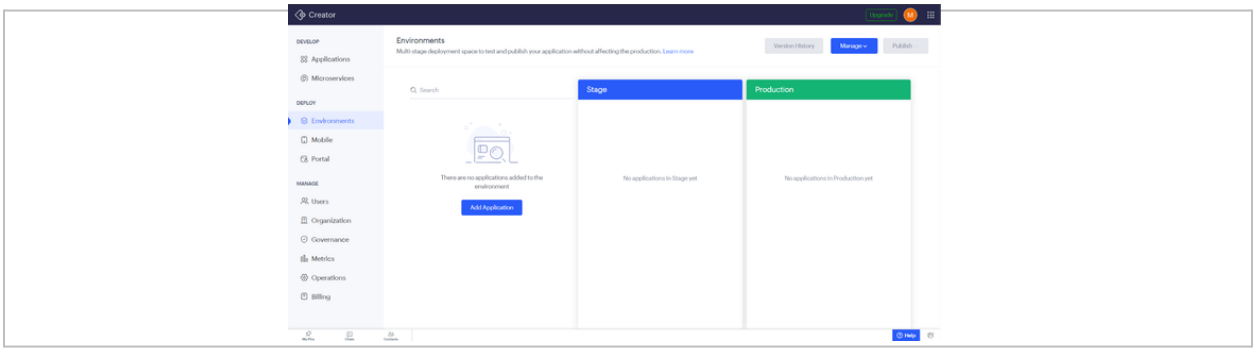


Fig. 2 — Environments page with Stage and Production columns (Production version 1.0)

3.4 Selecting components and comparing versions

In the Publish to Stage window, the modified component was selected from Forms > loan application > Fields. The code view shows Development and Staging side by side for each modified component, here the note field (plain) in the Section of the form. The Development code contains the updated note text, “Please verify your loan application details before submitting. Contact the bank for any corrections.”, while the Staging code still holds the earlier text.



Fig. 3 — Component selection and Development vs Staging code comparison

3.5 Publish details

The title was entered as *Bank Loan Application Form – Initial*, with the description “Initial deployment of the Bank Loan Application Form application from Development to Stage for testing.” The type was set to **Minor** (minimal changes and bug fixes), email notification was sent to the developer's registered address, and the version changed from V1.0 to V1.1. A warning stated that the application will be set to maintenance mode and inaccessible until publishing is complete.

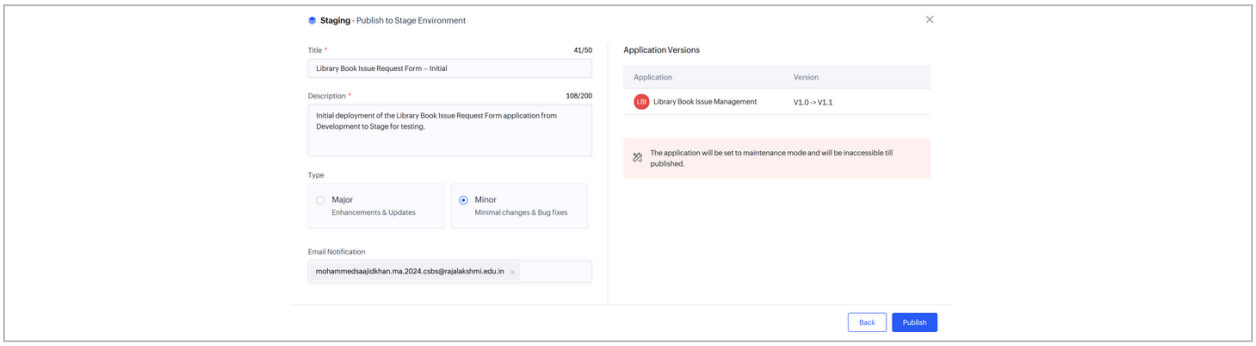


Fig. 4 — Publish to Stage form with title, description, type and version change

3.6 Stage deployment confirmation

After clicking Publish, Zoho Creator displayed “Publish to Stage initiated” and noted that the process takes a few minutes. A “successfully published to Stage” email from Zoho Creator confirmed that the version was published with current version 1.1. The Stage application was then opened from the Environments page, and the loan application form displayed the new note, confirming that the change reached Stage.

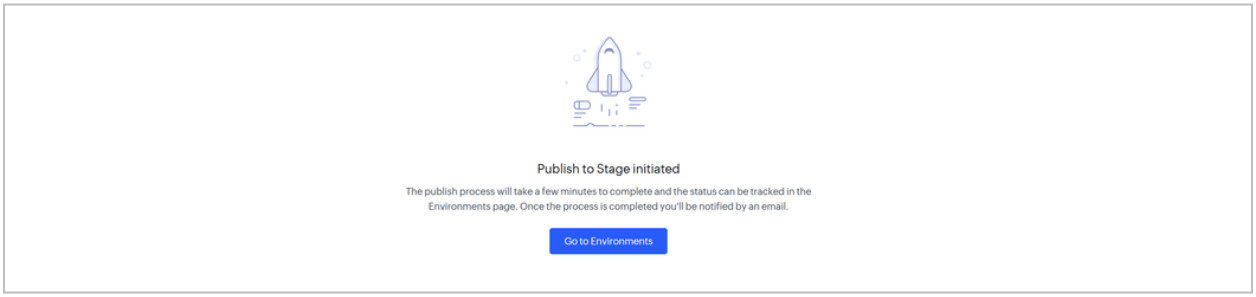


Fig. 5 — Publish to Stage initiated

3.7 Production deployment and live status

The tested version (Bank Loan Application Form – Initial, V1.1) was then published to Production using the Publish Now option. After a few minutes the Environments page showed the Production environment at version 1.1, with “No changes available” against the application.

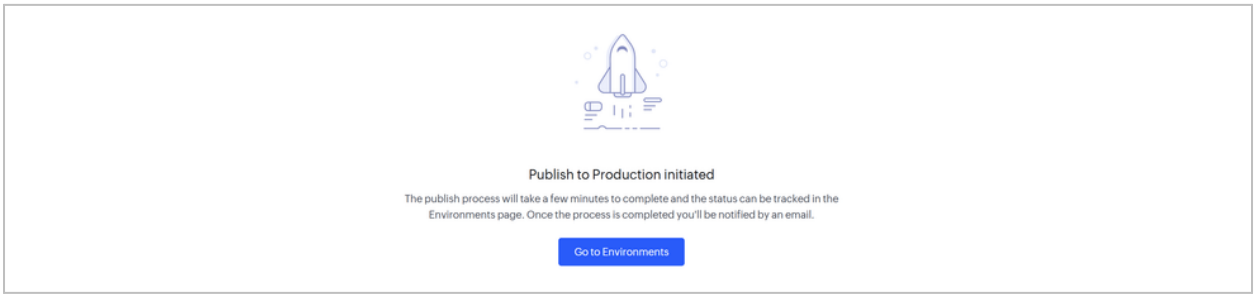


Fig. 7 — Publish to Production initiated

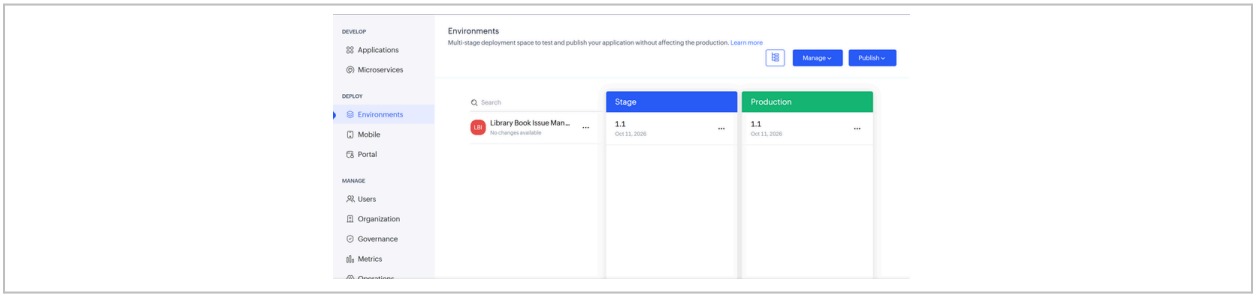


Fig. 8 — Environments page after deployment — Stage 1.1 and Production 1.1

3.8 Deployment summary

Environment	Version	Status	Description
Development	1.1	Published	Note added to the loan application form; no pending changes
Stage	1.1	Deployed	Version tested in Stage; note displayed on the form
Production	1.1	Live	Version published to Production after Stage testing

3.9 Deployment practices followed

The deployment followed good release practice: the modified component was reviewed and the Development and Staging code compared before publishing; the version was tested in Stage before Production; the release carried a clear title, description and version type; email notification was enabled and the Stage confirmation email was received; the maintenance-mode warning was noted; and the Environments page was checked after publishing.

4. Final Result

The Bank Loan Application Form application was deployed through the Zoho Creator multi-stage process. The modified note field of the loan application form was reviewed and published from Development to Stage as a Minor release (V1.0 to V1.1), confirmed by the Zoho Creator completion email. After testing, the version was published to Production, where the Environments page shows it at version 1.1.

The exercise met its objective of deploying a Zoho Creator application from the Development environment to the Production environment using controlled, traceable steps.